SwapIt — Local Setup on XAMPP

Option A: Setup wizard · Team onboarding guide

Before you start

- Install **XAMPP** (PHP 8.1+ and MySQL included).
- Clone or copy the project into: `C:\xampp\htdocs\swapit`
- Folder name should be **swapit** (lowercase) unless the whole team agrees on another name.

> **Important:** Use `http://localhost/swapit/...` — not port 8000 or 8080. XAMPP Apache runs on port **80** by default.

1 Start XAMPP

1. Open **XAMPP Control Panel**.
2. Click **Start** next to **Apache**.
3. Click **Start** next to **MySQL**.
4. Both modules should turn **green**.

If Apache fails to start, another program may be using port 80 (IIS, Skype, etc.). Close that app or change Apache's port in XAMPP config.

2 Open the setup wizard

In your browser, go to:

```
http://localhost/swapit/public/setup.php
```

3 Step 1 — Create config.php

Fill in the form with these values (default XAMPP):

Field	Value

App URL	`http://localhost/swapit` (no trailing slash)
DB Host	`localhost` or `127.0.0.1`
DB User	`root`
DB Password	*leave empty* (XAMPP default)
DB Name	`swapit`

Click the button to create `config.php`. You should see a success message.

> **Note:** `config.php` is not in Git. Every team member must create their own copy on their machine.

4 Step 2 — Import the database

On the same setup page, run **Step 2** to create the `swapit` database and import schema + sample data.

Alternatively, use phpMyAdmin (`http://localhost/phpmyadmin`):

1. Create database `swapit`
2. Import `database/schema.sql`
3. Import `database/seed.sql`

5 Open the website

Use these URLs:

Page	URL
Home	`http://localhost/swapit/src/config/pages/home.php`
Login	`http://localhost/swapit/src/config/pages/login.php`
Register	`http://localhost/swapit/src/config/pages/register.php`
Shortcut	`http://localhost/swapit/public`

6 Test that it works

- ☐ Home page loads without errors
- ☐ Register a new account (no “database error”)
- ☐ Enter the 6-digit verification code on the verify page
- ☐ Log in successfully

Common problems

Problem	Solution
Connection refused / site won’t load	Start Apache; use `localhost/swapit` not `:8000`
404 Not Found	Project must be in `htdocs\swapit`; URL must include `/swapit/`
Database or config errors	Create `config.php`; start MySQL; import SQL files
No verification email in Gmail	Normal on XAMPP — email doesn’t send locally. Use the dev code on the verify page or check `users.verify_token` in phpMyAdmin
Broken CSS / images	`APP_URL` in config must match folder name, e.g. `http://localhost/swapit`

Quick reference

One-line summary:
Put project in `C:\xampp\htdocs\swapit` → Start Apache + MySQL → Open `http://localhost/swapit/public/setup.php` → Set App URL to `http://localhost/swapit` → Import DB → Open home page.